Sweet Tooth, Sweetheart

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by Lunaeryi

Summary

Mydei doesn’t have a sweet tooth. Or at least, that’s what he insists—through stolen glances, midnight indulgences, and the occasional completely coincidental dessert theft. Phainon, of course, doesn’t believe him.

(Or: Five times Mydei stubbornly denied his love for sweets, and one time he didn’t.)

Notes

This is much shorter than the things I usually write, but I hope you guys still enjoy!

(If this is more up to par to things you want to read though, I can write more things like this too <3)

YALL HOLY SHIT??? SOMEONE MADE A COMIC ON THIS OMG HOW DID I NOT NOTICE IT SOONER IT’S SO PRETTY😭 https://x.com/pikminpurplest/status/1907458830667268375?s=46

See the end of the work for more notes

Bakery Incident

The bakery was a quiet place, almost too quiet for a meeting between two of Okhema's most infamous figures. Mydei and Phainon had just finished a tense discussion with the elders, and it was only natural that Phainon, ever the carefree one, sought out the nearest comfort. The warm smell of pastries and sugary confections filled the air as they entered, and Phainon's eyes lit up with childlike excitement.

"I told you," Phainon said with a grin, "this place is *legendary* for their frosting."

Mydei, ever the skeptic, arched a brow, though a small part of him couldn't help but feel curious. He had a weakness for sweets—just not enough to admit it aloud. He kept his attention on the pastries, scanning the display, acting like he was too busy to be distracted. Phainon, meanwhile, picked up a sugar-coated pastry, the kind that glistened with frosting, and took a bite with obvious satisfaction.

"Seriously, Mydei," Phainon urged, "you have to try this. It's *perfect* ."

Mydei barely glanced at him, but his eyes lingered on the smear of frosting that now decorated Phainon's lips. A subtle shift occurred within him, but he ignored it. He always ignored things like this.

"You're a messy eater, Snowy," Mydei remarked, using Tribbie's nickname for him with his voice dripping with mockery. His eyes never left the frosting, but his smirk said everything.

Phainon looked up, laughing softly. "You're the one who doesn't appreciate fine pastries. I'd say it's because you've got no taste, but I don't think you're as bad as that."

Phainon wiped his mouth with the back of his hand, but the frosting only smeared further, now trailing across his lips. Mydei's gaze dropped instinctively to it, and for a fleeting second, he caught himself thinking

about it more than he should. Phainon noticed the slight shift in his expression and chuckled again.

“What? You can’t stand a little mess, Mydei?” Phainon teased, his eyes twinkling.

Mydei’s heartbeat quickened, but he said nothing. Instead, he approached Phainon, his expression unreadable. Before Phainon could react, Mydei leaned in, almost as if compelled by something beyond his control. His lips brushed against Phainon’s in a swift, startling motion, and for a brief moment, time seemed to stand still.

Phainon froze, caught completely off guard. He hadn’t expected it—of course not. It was over almost as quickly as it began, with Mydei pulling away just as fast as he’d moved in. Phainon stared at him, wide-eyed, his mouth slightly agape.

Mydei quickly straightened, his voice thick with feigned nonchalance. “I thought I’d catch you off guard,” he said, shrugging like it was nothing. “You know, since you were making such a mess.” His smirk was sharp and self-assured, as if the whole thing had been planned.

Phainon blinked a couple of times, his brain clearly struggling to catch up. “You—you just *licked* frosting off my lips,” he managed, still processing.

Mydei turned his head, avoiding Phainon’s gaze, though a faint blush was creeping up his neck. He bit his lip in a vain attempt to hide his growing embarrassment. “I didn’t *lick* anything,” he muttered, rolling his eyes as he pretended to be disinterested. “It was just… efficient. No need for you to go and make a mess.”

But Phainon wasn’t letting it go that easily. A teasing smile spread across his face, a mix of amusement and something else—something softer, though it was hard to pinpoint. “Efficient, huh? Is that what we’re calling it now?” He stepped a little closer, his grin widening. “Sure didn’t look like efficiency to me.”

Mydei stiffened, his face still flushed but unwilling to acknowledge it. “You’re being ridiculous,” he grumbled, stepping away. “It’s not like I wanted to taste it, or anything.” He muttered the last part under his breath, though his words betrayed him.

Phainon tilted his head, clearly catching the hint. “So you *did* want to try it.” His voice was playful, his eyes dancing with mischief. “I’m not so sure I believe you, Mydei. Sounds like you have a bit of a sweet tooth after all.”

Mydei’s fingers twitched involuntarily, the idea of the frosting still fresh in his mind. He glanced at the counter where the pastries sat, their shiny layers of frosting glimmering in the light. He was so close to admitting it, but instead, he crossed his arms tightly, like the motion could ward off the thoughts plaguing him.

“I don’t know what you’re talking about,” Mydei said, more stiffly than before. “You’re just making something out of nothing.”

But Phainon, always the teasing one, wasn’t about to let him off the hook that easily. He nudged Mydei’s shoulder playfully. “It’s okay, Mydei,” he said, the teasing tone softening. “I won’t judge. You can always just admit that you wanted a little taste of it.”

Mydei rolled his eyes, but there was no denying the warmth that crept into his chest at the lightheartedness of it all. “I don’t care if you think I wanted to try it or not,” he muttered. “Let’s just get something else before you start making more of a mess.” He grabbed a pastry and walked to the counter with all the pretense of annoyance, but his hands were trembling slightly.

Phainon followed, still smiling, though now it was more of a fond expression. “I won’t make fun of you for it,” he said softly. “But you know, if you wanted more frosting…” He trailed off suggestively, leaving Mydei to stew in the awkwardness of the moment. Mydei huffed, unable to hide the grin tugging at the corner of his mouth.

“I don’t *want* more frosting,” he insisted, but his voice lacked its usual force. He could feel the subtle shift in the air, the unspoken understanding hanging between them.

Phainon didn’t press it further, but the shared moment of lightness was enough to make Mydei feel, for once, that maybe—just maybe—he could indulge a little in something sweet without needing to hide it.

As they left the bakery, the sweetness of the frosting lingered, both in their mouths and between them, even though neither of them said another word about it. Phainon glanced over at Mydei, who was already distracted by something else, but there was a warmth in his chest that he couldn’t quite explain.

Maybe he should listen to Phainon more often, this wasn’t so bad.

The Chocolate Revelation

It was a rare day that Mydei found himself in a situation where he wasn’t caught up in something serious or dealing with an endless stream of tasks. Today was one of those rare moments when he allowed himself to relax—if only for a few minutes. Phainon, ever the one to drag him out of his shell, had taken him to a small park outside the city, one of those hidden places that only people who knew Okhema well could find. The air was crisp, and the distant chatter of people seemed far away, making it the perfect place to unwind.

Mydei leaned back against the stone bench, watching the way the light filtered through the leaves overhead, casting a warm, golden glow on the path. Phainon had gone off to find a quiet spot where he could read, but of course, Mydei was left to his thoughts. After a few minutes, Phainon returned, holding a small packet in his hand.

“Look what I found,” Phainon said, grinning widely as he approached. He held out the packet, which was filled with dark chocolate—glistening with a rich, decadent sheen. “I know you *don’t* like sweets, but I thought we could share. Just this once.”

Mydei blinked, trying to mask the sudden flare of excitement that welled up inside him. It was *chocolate* . The one thing that he could never truly resist.

He had told Phainon a dozen times that he wasn't into sweets, but the lie always felt hollow. And now Phainon was offering it to him.

"Fine," Mydei said, trying to remain unaffected, his tone more dismissive than he felt. "I'll take one, but I'm not some child who needs to eat *sugar* all the time."

Phainon laughed, handing him a piece of chocolate. "Of course not. You just act like one sometimes." He winked, and Mydei rolled his eyes, hiding the smile tugging at his lips. He'd long since given up trying to stay mad at Phainon's playful jabs.

But as Mydei took the chocolate, his guard faltered for just a moment. The rich, bittersweet taste immediately filled his mouth, and for the first time in a while, he allowed himself to savor it. He took another piece, and then another, his usual composure slowly breaking down as his desire for more overtook his restraint.

Phainon watched him with a knowing look, though he said nothing at first. Mydei, caught in the indulgence of it all, finally noticed the quiet observation and cleared his throat, straightening himself as if to regain some control.

"What?" Mydei asked, his voice forced, as though he hadn't just eaten half the chocolate in a matter of seconds. "Is there something *wrong* with enjoying something for once?"

Phainon took a seat beside him, casually unwrapping his own piece of chocolate and taking a slow bite. "No," he said, his voice light. "Just didn't think you'd give in so easily."

Mydei stiffened, but only a little. He glared at the remaining pieces of chocolate in Phainon's hand, unwilling to admit how much he wanted more.

"Well, it's not like I'm going to eat *all* of it," he muttered, though his voice didn't carry the same confident edge it usually had. There was something about the way Phainon looked at him—knowing, teasing—that made it hard to keep up the charade.

“You don’t have to keep pretending, you know,” Phainon said with a grin, clearly enjoying the way Mydei was trying to cover up his obvious enjoyment. “You can have more if you want it.”

Mydei’s heart skipped, and for a moment, he froze. He didn’t want to seem like he was indulging too much, but the temptation was too great. He shifted uncomfortably, avoiding Phainon’s gaze as he grabbed another piece.

“I’m not addicted to it,” Mydei muttered as he popped the last piece of chocolate into his mouth, his fingers trembling just slightly. “I’m just… trying it. Just to see what the fuss is about.”

Phainon smirked, clearly satisfied with how much Mydei was trying to downplay the whole thing. “Sure, Mydei. Just seeing what the fuss is about.”

Mydei shot him a sideways glance, feeling the warmth spread across his face. He knew Phainon had figured him out. Of course, Phainon would know. He could never hide anything from him.

“Shut up,” Mydei said, though the affection was unmistakable in his tone. “It’s just chocolate. Doesn’t mean anything.”

Phainon, ever the tease, leaned in slightly, giving Mydei a knowing look. “I don’t mind,” he said softly. “You can have more if you want it. No one’s judging you for liking something sweet.”

Mydei hesitated, but the desire to keep up the act was fading. Instead, he finally allowed himself to relax and lean back into the bench, a small smile pulling at the corners of his lips. It was nice , he thought, to let go just a little. Phainon seemed content to let him be, and for once, Mydei didn’t mind being caught in the moment.

To Eat or Not to Eat

It had been a long day of training, and Mydei's patience was worn thin. The sparring session with Phainon had been grueling, the tension between them palpable as they each tested the other's limits. While Phainon was his usual self—teasing, carefree, and annoyingly persistent—Mydei was far less amused. He wanted to be left alone, to calm his mind, but there was something that kept tugging at him, distracting him.

A small store tucked between two narrow streets, only a few steps from their usual training ground, had recently opened, selling handmade chocolates and confections. Mydei had tried to ignore the scents that drifted in his direction after every training session, but it was becoming increasingly difficult. He could feel his stomach growling as they walked by.

Phainon, ever the observant one, noticed the subtle shift in Mydei's posture when they neared the shop. A slight tension in his shoulders, a glance toward the window, and a hint of longing that Mydei would never admit.

"Something you're not telling me, Mydei?" Phainon asked with a knowing smile, his voice teasing.

Mydei forced himself to look away, focusing on the path ahead. "Nothing. I'm fine." His tone was dismissive, but Phainon didn't buy it. Not for a second.

They passed the window, but Phainon's eyes lingered on Mydei. "You sure? Because you've been eyeing that shop like it holds all the answers."

"I'm not interested in their overpriced candy," Mydei muttered, his words sharp, but his stomach betrayed him with another loud growl. He winced at the sound, hoping Phainon hadn't heard it.

Phainon smirked. "You know, I don't think I've ever seen you so interested in something so trivial before."

Mydei bit back a groan, wishing he could simply hide his cravings. He hated the way Phainon seemed to see through him with ease. "It's not like that."

“Oh, is it not?” Phainon said, moving closer, his voice dropping to a conspiratorial tone. “You’ve got that look in your eye. A certain… *sweet* look.”

Mydei clenched his jaw, determined to stay indifferent. “You’re imagining things.”

Phainon stopped walking and turned toward the shop with a mock sigh. “Well, since you seem so resolute about not wanting any, I guess I’ll go grab some for myself. It’s too bad, really. I was hoping you’d indulge just a little.”

Mydei’s pulse quickened, and despite himself, he found his feet moving toward the shop. “You’re ridiculous. I don’t need any.”

Phainon didn’t miss the movement. “Uh-huh. Sure.” He grinned, stepping into the shop without waiting for Mydei to catch up. “But you’re coming with me, whether you admit it or not.”

They entered, and the scent of chocolate hit Mydei like a wave. The rich, sweet aroma wrapped around him, and he felt a faint flush creep up his neck. He glanced at Phainon, who was already picking out several bars and truffles with a mischievous look on his face.

“I’ll take the dark chocolate,” Phainon said, almost too casually, “and maybe a little of that caramel-filled one for you. You know, since you’re not admitting to anything.”

Mydei opened his mouth to protest, but the words died in his throat. He couldn’t stop the longing that flickered in his eyes, or the way his hands instinctively reached for the delicate box of truffles. He stood there, frozen, as Phainon paid for the treats.

Phainon handed him a small box, a knowing glint in his eyes. “Here, take it. I don’t want to hear any more protests. You don’t have to admit it now, but maybe next time, you’ll stop pretending you don’t have a sweet tooth.”

Mydei’s face burned, and he took the box from Phainon without a word. He couldn’t resist. Not anymore. The truffles were as rich and indulgent as he’d imagined, and he savored the taste as he took a bite. Phainon was watching him closely, his grin wide and triumphant.

“See?” Phainon said, his voice warm with amusement. “It’s okay to admit it. You don’t always have to be so serious .”

Mydei swallowed and looked away, trying to hide the small smile tugging at the corner of his lips. “I didn’t ask for your commentary, Snowy.”

Phainon only laughed, his carefree demeanor not at all disturbed by Mydei’s gruff response. “I think I prefer this side of you,” he said, glancing at the truffles. “Less grumpy, more sweet.”

Mydei huffed but didn’t argue. He wasn’t ready to admit it, but in that moment, he can feel his heart stuttering somewhat at Phainon’s actions, all for him huh?

No one needed to know that, though.

The Festival Incident

Okhema’s festival was in full swing, filling the city with the scent of sizzling meats, spiced drinks, and, most temptingly, sweets of all kinds. Stalls lined the streets, colorful banners swaying above crowds of people eager to sample the best their city had to offer. Mydei had no intention of lingering—he hated events like this. Too loud, too crowded, too many people pretending everything was fine when it wasn’t.

But of course, Phainon had other plans.

“This is a rare occasion, Mydei,” Phainon said, walking beside him, eyes flickering with amusement. “You should enjoy yourself for once.”

“I’ll enjoy it when it’s over,” Mydei replied dryly, tucking his hands into his cloak.

Phainon ignored him, scanning the festival stalls like a child overwhelmed by options. Then, as if struck by divine inspiration, his eyes locked onto something in the distance, and a slow, knowing grin spread across his face.

Mydei's stomach sank. He knew that look.

Moments later, Phainon had dragged him to a stall selling golden, honey-drenched pastries, dusted with spices and crushed nuts. The vendor was already packing a generous portion, and Mydei glared as Phainon handed over a few coins.

"I'm not eating that," Mydei said, crossing his arms.

Phainon plucked a piece from the plate and took a dramatic bite, humming in satisfaction. "That's fine. More for me."

Mydei rolled his eyes. Typical.

Then came the mistake.

"Mydei! Lord Phainon!"

A group of younger warriors from Okhema's guard approached, their expressions bright with curiosity. Mydei's scowl deepened—he wasn't in the mood to entertain them.

One of them, a girl barely past her initiation trials, eyed the pastries. "Oh, those look amazing," she said. "I heard these are supposed to bring good luck if you eat them during the festival."

"Is that so?" Phainon said, his voice deceptively light. "Then it'd be a shame if Mydei didn't have one."

Mydei shot him a warning glare, but Phainon only smiled wider.

"You *are* going to eat one, right?" one of the warriors asked, looking genuinely expectant. "It's tradition, after all."

There was no escape. If he refused, it’d be another reason for people to whisper about him—Mydei, the cold-hearted heir, always too distant, too detached to even eat a sweet offered to him. If he agreed, he’d have to eat it in front of them, in front of Phainon .

With the smallest sigh of defeat, he reached for a pastry, breaking off a piece and popping it into his mouth.

It was—

Damn it. It was *good* .

Crisp, warm, soaked in honey but balanced by the spice and nuts. The texture melted on his tongue, and a surge of warmth spread through him. But even as his body betrayed him, he kept his face blank, chewing slowly, as if it was nothing special.

Phainon was watching. *Of course he was watching.*

“How is it?” one of the guards asked eagerly.

Mydei swallowed. “It’s fine.”

Phainon snorted. “ *Fine* , he says, after looking like he just had a religious experience.”

Mydei shot him a sharp glare. “Shut up.”

The warriors laughed, clearly entertained, and the conversation shifted. Mydei forced himself to remain impassive as they talked, but Phainon never stopped looking at him with that infuriating, knowing grin.

Later, when the warriors left and the festival continued around them, Phainon leaned in and murmured, “You didn’t even pretend to hate that one.”

Mydei refused to dignify him with a response.

But when Phainon wasn’t looking, he went back to that stall and took a few more, for research purposes of course.

The Midnight Theft

The halls of the estate were silent at this hour, the usual clamor of politics and feigned civility drowned in the stillness of the night. Mydei wasn’t meant to be here—not lingering outside the kitchen, not standing in the dim glow of the lanterns like a thief debating his crime.

He could leave. *He should leave.*

Instead, he moved.

His footsteps were soundless as he entered the kitchen, eyes scanning the space with trained precision. He knew exactly where they were. He’d seen them earlier that day—left on the cooling racks, carefully arranged, waiting for morning.

Algaea’s chefs always prepared elaborate desserts, and normally, Mydei ignored them with practiced ease. But tonight, after an exhausting evening of dealing with people who thought themselves important and the elders with their nagging, he had found himself thinking about them.

The honeyed date cakes.

He had no reason to want them. No reason to be standing here now, slipping past the counters, reaching for the carefully stacked tray.

Still, he plucked one from the pile, pressing his thumb against its soft, syrupy surface. Just one. No one would notice. He brought it to his lips, taking a slow, deliberate bite—

“You’re an awful thief.”

Mydei’s heart nearly stopped.

He turned sharply, already glaring, only to find Phainon leaning against the doorway, arms crossed, expression filled with amusement. The bastard knew.

“What are you doing here?” Mydei asked, voice carefully even.

Phainon tilted his head. “I could ask you the same.”

Mydei dusted his fingers off, as if the crumbs on them were of no consequence. “I was hungry.”

“Of course,” Phainon drawled. “And you just happened to go for the sweetest thing in the kitchen. Not, say, the bread. Or the leftovers from dinner.”

Mydei took another bite out of sheer defiance, chewing slowly. “It was convenient.”

Phainon exhaled a laugh, stepping closer. “You know, for someone so smart, you’re terrible at lying.”

Mydei swallowed, narrowing his eyes. “I don’t have a sweet tooth.”

Phainon hummed in mock agreement. “No, of course not.” Then, before Mydei could react, Phainon reached forward and wiped a stray bit of honey from the corner of Mydei’s mouth. He held up his finger, golden syrup glistening, and grinned. “You’re just stealing desserts in the dead of night for fun, then?”

Mydei *refused* to rise to the bait. Instead, he plucked another cake from the tray, shoved it against Phainon’s chest, and muttered, “Eat this and shut up.”

Phainon took it without hesitation, clearly delighted. “You know, Mydei, if you wanted sweets, you could’ve just asked me to buy you some.”

“I don’t want sweets.”

Phainon smirked. “Right. Just ‘convenient’ ones.”

Mydei said nothing, biting into the last of his stolen cake with perfect indifference. If Phainon thought he had won something here, he was sorely mistaken.

(He had definitely won something.)

Sweet Tooth, Sweetheart

The rain had been falling for hours, steady and rhythmic against the windows of Phainon's home. It wasn't often that Mydei found himself here—not because he wasn't welcome, but because he rarely allowed himself to linger anywhere that wasn't necessary.

Tonight was different.

The storm had rolled in fast, drenching the streets before he could return by himself somewhere with shelter, Phainon, ever the opportunist, had all but *dragged* him inside before he could protest. Now, the fire crackled in the hearth, casting warm light over the room, and the scent of something rich and sweet drifted in from the kitchen.

Phainon was at the counter, humming to himself as he plated something, and Mydei, seated on the couch with a borrowed blanket draped over his shoulders, watched him with a wary sort of suspicion.

"I didn't ask for anything," Mydei said, voice low.

"You didn't have to," Phainon replied, carrying two plates over.

He set one in front of Mydei, revealing a slice of something golden and delicate, dusted with powdered sugar. The other plate was for himself, though his was already missing a bite.

"Melopita," Phainon said casually, taking another forkful. "Figured you'd like it."

Mydei frowned, fingers tightening slightly around the edge of his blanket. “You—” He stopped, uncertain. *You made this for me?* The words felt too heavy, too close to something he wasn’t ready to say aloud.

Phainon didn’t press him. He just gave Mydei a small, knowing smile and turned his attention back to his own plate.

For a long moment, Mydei didn’t move.

Then, with slow deliberation, he picked up the fork.

The first bite was warm and soft, subtly sweet with honey and just a hint of cinnamon. It melted on his tongue, the kind of comfort that settled deep in his bones. He exhaled slowly, letting his eyes close for just a second longer than necessary.

Phainon didn’t tease him. Didn’t smirk or throw some smug remark his way. He only watched, quiet and content, as Mydei took another bite.

When Mydei finally spoke, his voice was softer than before. “It’s good.”

Phainon grinned. “I know.”

Silence stretched between them—not the tense kind, not the kind that meant something unsaid lingered in the air. Just quiet, easy and warm.

For the first time, Mydei didn’t hide it. He didn’t scoff, didn’t feign indifference, didn’t act like it was just *convenient*.

He just ate, letting the honeyed sweetness settle on his tongue, and for once, he let himself enjoy it.

End Notes

Uhh you’re saying I wrote this as a distraction because idk what to write for the middle part of chapter 3 of False Deliverer? That’s crazy, hahaha…

Tell me you’re thoughts on this everyone, and finally, thanks for reading❤

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!